

It is easy to invite joy into your life

Something good happens to you – you cleared an examination, your blood test results are great, you just got that **long-awaited** promotion at work – and you feel **overjoyed**. You **radiate** that happiness to all around you and life is generally **on a roll**. The **moment** all that's listed above **happens** to someone else – and you have failed the exam, your cholesterol is high, and you did not get the raise or promotion you expected at work – you start burning with jealousy, you are angry, and you radiate all these negative feelings, making yourself and those around you **miserable**. Why is it so difficult to feel happy for your colleague or friend who **managed** to achieve those things?

When you **take delight in** the happiness of others, the Buddhists call it *mudita*. It means **sympathetic** joy. Physician turned **mindfulness** and dharma teacher Christiane Wolf writes of the Buddha's **exposition** of the four *brahmaviharas*, the highest qualities of the heart. They are, *metta*, loving-kindness; *karuna*, **compassion**; *upeksha*, **equanimity** and *mudita*, sympathetic joy. Of these, *mudita* is **perhaps** the most challenging as it requires you to feel happy at the achievements of others. **Jealousy** among colleagues and even strangers **is somewhat comprehensible** but to **resent** the success of one's own sibling or parent, or even child, is something that is really **gross**. Instead of feeling joy and love, you feel **violated**, that how come this is not happening to you, and why is it happening to them? Why not me, why them?

The first step towards **cultivating** the quality of *mudita*, to feel joy at the happiness of others, **is** to learn to look at your own self more sympathetically. Appreciate your good qualities, your plus points and maintain a decent degree of **self-esteem**. **Uncover** your strengths. Once you do that, there will be no **room** for feelings of insecurity and **inferiority** because you are beginning to realise your own worth. Once this is done, you will find it difficult not to feel joy for others, because you have begun to learn the art of inviting joy into your life. Because you know now how to feel joy within yourself. So, feeling happy for others is only the next step.

Once you have stopped being a **party pooper**, always seeing the negative side of things, so critical and ever complaining, you will see that all of these have been preventing you from experiencing what you really deserve, to feel **wonder** and joy at your own self and in your life. These positive feelings will begin to radiate outside of you as well, and naturally, when something good happens to others, you, too, feel **elated**. You are no longer a drag, **held back** by dark thoughts that prevent you and others from participating in the **euphoria** of life.

The four **brahmaviharas** mentioned earlier, also known as the **immeasurables**, **are** all inter-connected, and once you are in the process of cultivating them, you will find it very difficult **indeed** to keep joy out of your life. This is **aptly summed up** in the **following** Sanskrit prayer: "Lokah samastah sukhino bhavantu." That is, once we **strive** to end our own **suffering** and have good thoughts for ourselves and others, we will wish happiness for everyone in the world. It's an ancient but timeless **affirmation**.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

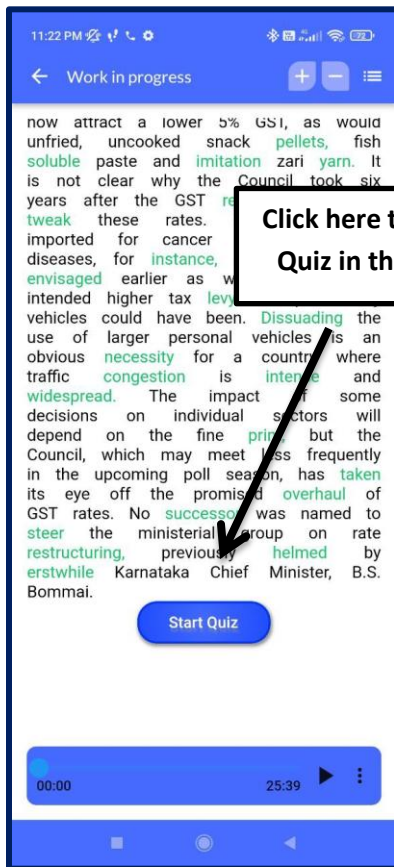
1. **Long-awaited** (adjective) – Much-anticipated, eagerly awaited, expected, eagerly anticipated, awaited with excitement लंबे समय से प्रतीक्षित
2. **Overjoyed** (adjective) – Extremely happy, delighted, ecstatic, elated, thrilled अत्यंत प्रसन्न
3. **Radiate** (verb) – Emit, exude, project, emanate, give off प्रसारित करना
4. **On a roll** (phrase) – Experiencing a period of success, doing well continuously, in a streak of good fortune लगातार सफलता मिलना
5. **Miserable** (adjective) – Unhappy, sorrowful, dejected, distressed, wretched दुखी
6. **Manage** (to) (verb) – Succeed in, accomplish, achieve, be able to, pull off सफल होना
7. **Take delight in** (phrase) – Enjoy, relish, find pleasure in, savor, be pleased with आनंद लेना
8. **Sympathetic** (adjective) – Compassionate, understanding, supportive, empathetic, caring सहानुभूतिपूर्ण
9. **Mindfulness** (noun) – Awareness, attentiveness, consciousness, focus, presence of mind सचेतना
10. **Exposition** (noun) – a comprehensive description and explanation of an idea or theory. व्याख्या
11. **Compassion** (noun) – Empathy, kindness, mercy, sympathy, understanding करुणा
12. **Equanimity** (noun) – Calmness, composure, serenity, tranquility, evenness of temper समभाव
13. **Perhaps** (adverb) – Maybe, possibly, conceivably, perchance, it could be शायद
14. **Somewhat** (adverb) – Slightly, to some extent, a little, moderately, partially कुछ हद तक
15. **Comprehensible** (adjective) – Understandable, intelligible, clear, graspable, lucid बोधगम्य
16. **Resent** (verb) – Feel bitter about, begrudge, dislike, take offense at, be annoyed by नाराज़ होना
17. **Gross** (adjective) – Obvious, glaring, blatant, flagrant; in this context: inappropriate, unacceptable घोर
18. **Violated** (adjective) – Breached, infringed, disrespected, dishonored, transgressed आहत
19. **Cultivate** (verb) – Develop, foster, nurture, encourage, build विकसित करना

20. **Self-esteem** (noun) – Self-respect, confidence, self-worth, dignity, self-regard
आत्म-सम्मान
21. **Uncover** (verb) – Discover, reveal, find out, expose, bring to light खोज निकालना
22. **Room** (noun) – Space, opportunity, scope, capacity, allowance गुंजाइश
23. **Inferiority** (noun) – Low self-worth, inadequacy, subordination, lesser quality, inferiority complex हीनता
24. **Party pooper** (noun) – Spoilsport, killjoy, dampener, someone who ruins the fun मज़ा खराब करने वाला व्यक्ति
25. **Wonder** (verb) – Marvel, be amazed, be in awe, admire, be astonished आश्चर्य करना
26. **Elated** (adjective) – Overjoyed, delighted, ecstatic, thrilled, jubilant प्रसन्नचित्त
27. **Hold back** (phrasal verb) – Restrain, inhibit, keep back, prevent, suppress रोकना
28. **Euphoria** (noun) – Intense happiness, joy, elation, bliss, exhilaration उत्साह
29. **Immeasurable** (noun) – Something that is limitless, boundless, infinite, incalculable असीम
30. **Indeed** (adverb) – Certainly, in fact, truly, actually, really वास्तव में
31. **Aptly** (adverb) – Appropriately, suitably, fittingly, aptly, correctly उचित रूप से
32. **Sum up** (phrasal verb) – Summarize, encapsulate, conclude, recapitulate, wrap up सारांश प्रस्तुत करना
33. **Following** (preposition) – After, subsequent to, succeeding, ensuing के बाद
34. **Strive** (to) (verb) – Endeavor, try hard, attempt, aim, struggle प्रयास करना
35. **Suffering** (noun) – Pain, distress, hardship, agony, affliction दुख
36. **Affirmation** (noun) – Positive assertion, declaration, confirmation, endorsement, proclamation सकारात्मक कथन

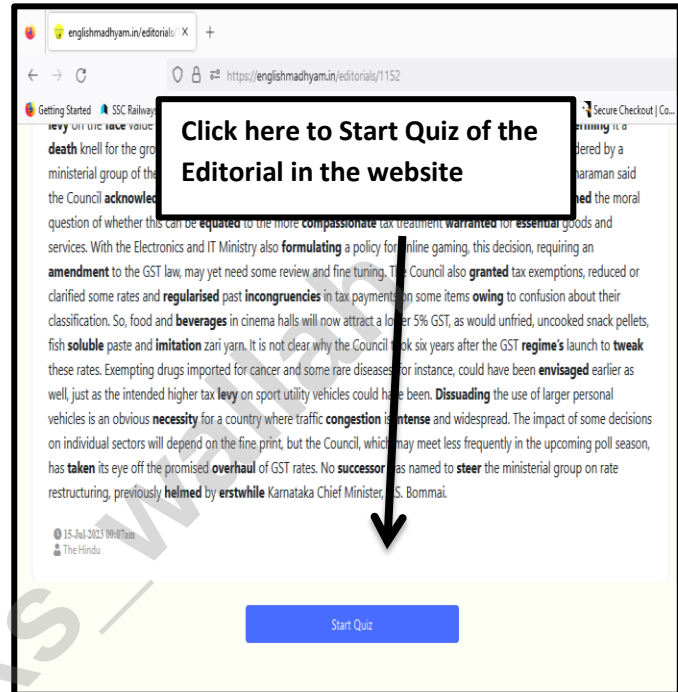
Summary of the Editorial

1. Joy comes easily when good things happen to you, like passing an exam or getting a promotion.
2. Experiencing setbacks, like failing an exam or missing a promotion, often leads to feelings of jealousy and negativity.
3. Feeling happy for others' successes is challenging and rare for many.
4. Buddhists call the act of feeling joy for others' happiness "mudita," meaning sympathetic joy.
5. The four brahmaviharas—metta (loving-kindness), karuna (compassion), upeksha (equanimity), and mudita (sympathetic joy)—represent the highest qualities of the heart.
6. Mudita is considered the most difficult brahmavihara to practice because it challenges feelings of envy and comparison.
7. Jealousy is common, but resenting the success of loved ones is particularly distressing and unnatural.
8. The journey to feeling genuine joy for others starts with appreciating and valuing yourself.
9. Building self-esteem and recognizing your strengths reduce feelings of inferiority and insecurity.
10. As you learn to find joy within yourself, feeling happy for others becomes a natural progression.
11. Letting go of negativity, criticism, and complaints opens up opportunities for true happiness.
12. Positive feelings, when cultivated, radiate outward and enhance relationships with others.
13. Overcoming negative emotions like envy leads to genuine euphoria for others' achievements.
14. The four brahmaviharas are interwoven, and practicing them brings holistic joy and well-being.
15. The Sanskrit prayer "Lokah samastah sukhino bhavantu" reminds us to wish happiness for all and end suffering through positive and loving intentions.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



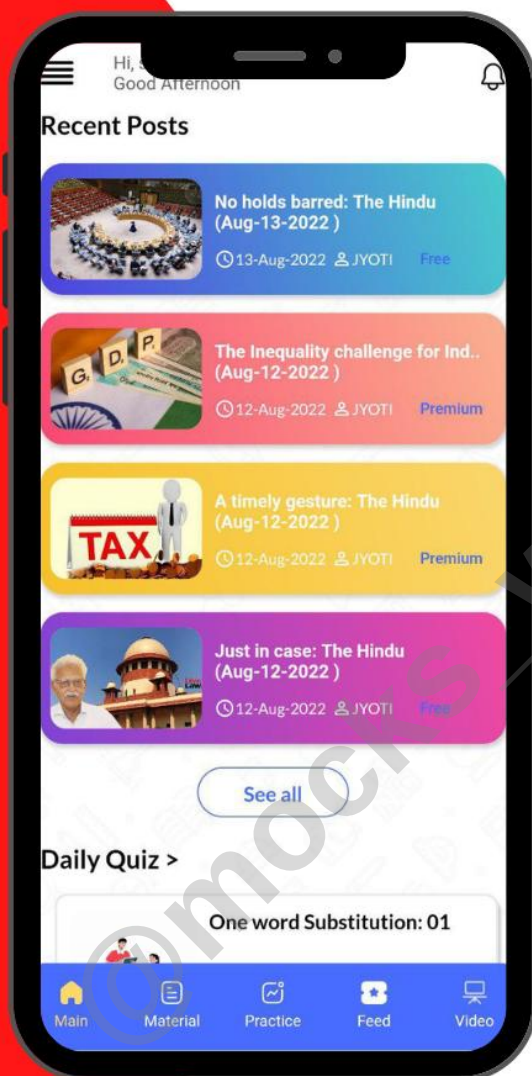
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